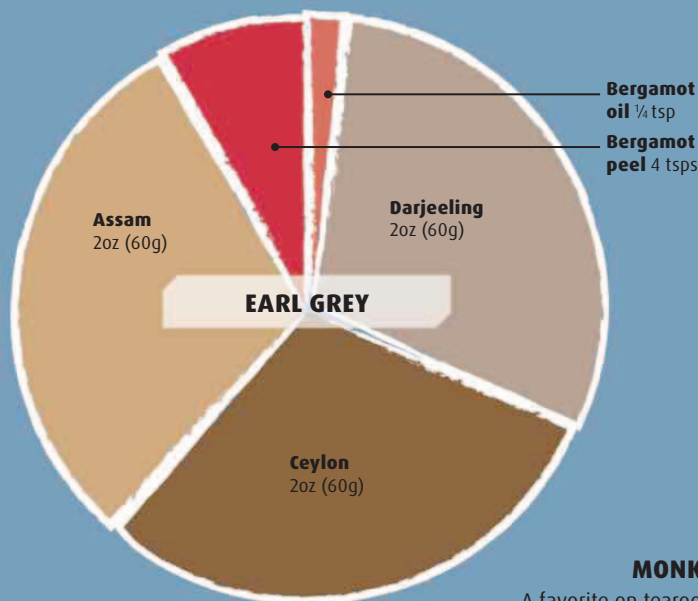
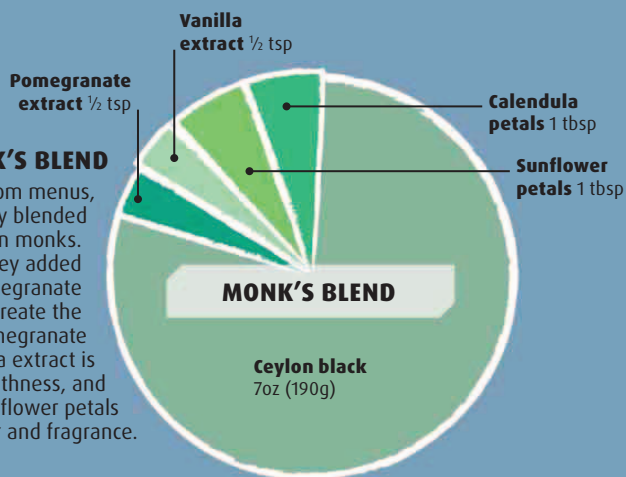




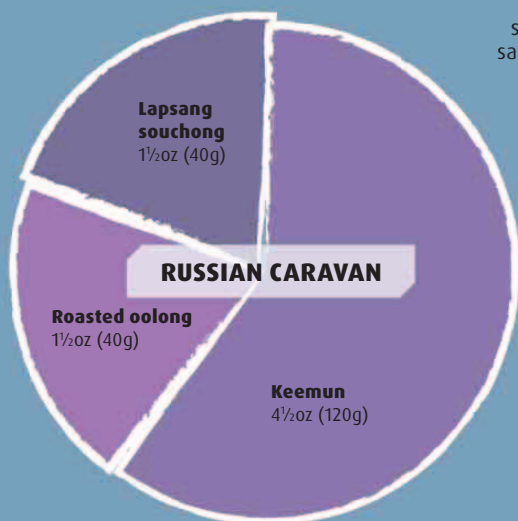
EARL GREY

This is a refreshing blend that has been around in varying strengths since Earl Grey was appointed Prime Minister of the United Kingdom in 1830. This classic blend comprises three black teas—Darjeeling and Ceylon, which bring a lightness to the cup, and Assam, a malty tea that adds depth. The characteristic fragrance of this blend comes from the addition of bergamot oil and bergamot peel. You could use mandarin peel in place of bergamot peel.



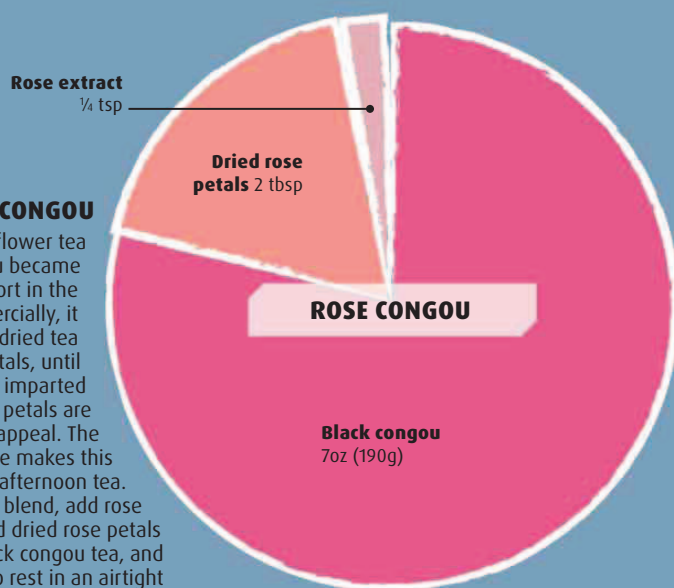
MONK'S BLEND

A favorite on tearoom menus, this tea was originally blended by Franciscan monks. Traditionally, they added grenadine, a pomegranate syrup, but you can create the same effect with pomegranate extract. Vanilla extract is added for smoothness, and calendula and sunflower petals for color and fragrance.



RUSSIAN CARAVAN

This comforting blend is made from three Chinese black teas—Keemun, Lapsang Souchong, and roasted oolong—and pays homage to the camel caravans that delivered tea and other goods from China to Russia in the 19th century. The journey was long, usually lasting many months, and the tea was subjected to campfire smoke and exposed to the elements. This tea brings to mind the sweet smell of a wood fire, with just a little smokiness for those who don't like Lapsang Souchong's tarry taste on its own.



ROSE CONGOU

A traditional fragrant flower tea of China, Rose Congou became a popular English import in the 18th century. Commercially, it is made by layering dried tea leaves and rose petals, until the flowers' oils are imparted to the tea. Often, rose petals are added for visual appeal. The sweetness of rose makes this a popular choice for afternoon tea. To make your own blend, add rose extract and dried rose petals to Chinese black congou tea, and allow to rest in an airtight container for several days.